

DEXASONE



Tablet

(Dexasone 0.5 mg Tablet)

Name and Strength of Active Substance(s)

Dexamethasone 0.5mg

Product Description

Dexamethasone Tablet is long, flat faced bevel-edged tablet with scored on one side and imprinted 'ATC' on the other side, the colour of tablet is light green.

Pharmacodynamics

Dexamethasone is a corticosteroid of the glucocorticoid class, of which cortisone and the naturally occurring hydrocortisone belong Dexamethasone is about 25 times more potent than cortisone acetate. The glucocorticoid steroid actions are mainly anti-inflammatory, anti-allergic and anti-rheumatic in conditions such as asthma and rheumatoid arthritis. It appears that a measure of corticosteroid's potency as a glucocorticoid is the degree of inhibition of corticotrophin secretion it produces.

Dexamethasone has immunosuppressant properties and can be administered to reduce immune response after organ transplants.

In rheumatoid arthritis the effects of dexamethasone are suppressive and palliative, prompt symptomatic relief with diminution of joint swelling, effusion and pain occur.

However the symptoms return on cessation of treatment. Dexamethasone can improve ventilation and relief symptom in patients with bronchial asthma and are used when bronchodilator drugs such as adrenaline, aminophylline, isoprenaline or salbutamol are inadequate.

Pharmacokinetics

Dexasone is absorbed from gastro-intestinal tract. Administration by mouth gives a more rapid response than an intramuscular injection of an insoluble corticosteroid. In the circulation, dexamethasone is bound to the plasma protein, but to a lesser extent than for other corticosteroid mainly to globulin and less to albumin. The corticoid-binding has high affinity but low binding capacity, while the albumin had low affinity but large binding capacity.

Only unbound dexamethasone has pharmacological effects or it's metabolized. Corticosteroids diffuses into tissue fluids and cerebrospinal fluids but Trans placental diffusion in significant amounts had been demonstrated.

Corticosteroids are metabolized in the liver and kidney and excreted in the urine. The slower metabolism and lower protein binding affinity of dexamethasone may account for its increased potency compared with the natural corticosteroids.

The biological half-life in plasma of dexamethasone is about 190 minutes. Peak plasma concentration after oral administration occurred after 1 to 3 hours.

Indication

Management of the symptoms and symptomatic relief of rheumatoid arthritis, rheumatic fever, status asmaticus, other inflammatory conditions and ulcerative colitis. It is useful in the treatment of nephrotic oedema as it can produce diuresis.

Recommended Dosage

Adult: One to four tablets daily.

If necessary up to 20 tablets daily in conditions dangerous to life, such as pemphigus vulgaris, leukemia, and acute hemolytic crisis.

Route of Administration

Dexasone Tablet 0.5mg administered orally.

Contraindications

Care should be taken in treating diabetic patients as insulin requirements are usually increased during administration of dexamethasone. There is a risk of peptic ulceration and caution should exercise when used on such patients as relapse and hemorrhage may occur. Dexamethasone should be avoided when tuberculosis is present and care should be taken when infection are present particular systemic fungal or herpes infection.

Warnings and Precautions

Care should be taken in treating diabetic patients, as insulin requirements are usually increased during administration of dexamethasone patients should be warned of this particularly, those who self-administer insulin.

Interaction with other medicament

Not applicable.

Statement on usage during pregnancy and lactation

Dexamethasone should not be used in pregnancy particularly within the first 14 weeks and only used with caution in nursing mother.

Adverse Effects/ Undesirable Effects

Sodium retention, oedema, electrolyte imbalance and Cushing's syndrome, withdrawal syndrome, aggravation of fungal and herpes infections.

Overdose and Treatment

Over dosages are comparatively rare and if ingested, emetic maybe of help. Gastric lavage may also be of value. Due to its low protein binding affinity, peritoneal dialysis maybe instituted.

Storage Conditions

Store below 30°C

Protect from light.

Dosage forms and packaging available

DEXASONE TABLET 0.5mg packed in aluminium foil strip. 10 tablets per strips in box of 50 x 10.

Manufacturer

ATLANTIC LABORATORIES CORPORATION LTD.

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Product Registration Holder

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